Grant Proposal Process

If you qualify for a grant by operating a conforming program (see *Grantmaking Guidelines* to check), you may apply for a grant. The process is different for ***small grants*** up to $5,000 and for ***regular grants*** larger than $5,000.

Process for Small Grants

All applicants complete a simple process for small grants. A *Small Grant Proposal* is completed and, along with up to five supporting documents, submitted to a local Credit Union branch manager or the Foundation office. The procedure is summarized below.

1. A *Small Grant Proposal* is submitted (see the form for instructions).
2. The Foundation reviews the *Small Grant Proposal* for:
   i. conformity to granting guidelines, and
   ii. its projected program outcomes
3. The Foundation conducts limited due diligence on the organization and the program for which it has proposed a grant.
4. Foundation staff carefully consider the *Small Grant Proposal*, and decide:
   i. recommendation for approval or denial
   ii. if approved: terms, conditions, changes to the *Proposal*
   iii. grant size
5. Quarterly, the Foundation directors will review the proposals recommended by staff for funding. A two-thirds vote of directors is required for approval.
6. A *Distribution Agreement Letter* is sent to organizations with approved *Small Grant Proposals*.
7. A *Notification of Decline Letter* is sent to unsuccessful applicants.
8. Upon return of the signed *Distribution Agreement Letter*, a check will be issued.

Process for Regular Grants

Each applicant for a regular grant of more than $5,000 will fit within one of two categories:

- Self-initiated applicant
- Foundation-invited applicant (generally, prior grantees)

The starting point for a self-initiated applicant is a *Letter of Inquiry*. Once a *Letter of Inquiry* is submitted and approved, self-initiated and Foundation-invited applicants follow the same procedure, as summarized below.

For Self-initiated Applicants

1. Applicant submits a *Letter of Inquiry* (see p. 2 for instructions).
2. The Foundation responds with an invitation to submit a *Grant Proposal*, or a denial.

For Foundation-invited Applicants

3. The Foundation invites the applicant to submit a *Grant Proposal.*

All Applicants

4. A *Grant Proposal* is submitted (see p. 3 for instructions).

5. The Foundation reviews the *Grant Proposal* for:
   i. conformity to granting guidelines, and
   ii. its projected program outcomes
6. The Foundation conducts due diligence on the organization and the program for which it has proposed a grant.
7. Foundation staff carefully consider the *Grant Proposal*, and decide:
   i. recommendation for approval or denial
   ii. if approved: terms, conditions, changes to the Proposal
   iii. grant size
8. Quarterly, the Foundation directors will review the proposals recommended by staff for funding. A two-thirds vote of directors is required for approval.
9. A *Distribution Agreement Letter* is sent to organizations with approved *Grant Proposals*.
10. A *Notification of Decline Letter* is sent to unsuccessful applicants.
11. Upon return of the signed *Distribution Agreement Letter*, a check will be issued.

Preparing a Letter of Inquiry

Qualified applicants with a conforming program may submit a *Letter of Inquiry* regarding a proposed grant. This is for self-initiated applicants; if the Foundation asks to you apply for a grant, this step is skipped. Currently, *Letters of Inquiry* are considered quarterly and are due no later than February 28, May 30, August 31, or November 30 each year.

A *Letter of Inquiry* must meet the following guidelines:

1. Typed on your organization's official letterhead
2. Signed by the CEO, a vice president, or a member of the senior management team
3. Not more than two pages in length, using standard type
4. Include no attachments (exception: a core values statement may be included)
5. Mailed to:
   Ms. Marin Kraushaar
   Executive Director
   Georgia's Own Foundation, Inc.
   1155 Peachtree Street
   Post Office Box 105205
   Atlanta, GA 30348

The *Letter* must address the following topics:

1. ***Purpose.*** The purpose, or mission, of the organization.
2. ***Organization Profile.*** What it is and what it does.
3. ***Organizational Strategy.*** The approach the organization uses to achieve its mission (high level only, details not required).
4. ***Population Served.*** The primary persons served by the organization and their need for services (what problems you address).
5. ***Program Description.*** Snapshot of the program for which you seek support—what it seeks to achieve, for whom, and how.
6. ***Outcomes.*** What outcomes the program achieves for the persons served—changes in behavior, skill, knowledge, attitude, or situation.
7. ***Use of Funds.*** The exact purpose for which funds would be requested.

8. ***Contact Person.*** The name and contact details for the person who would submit a *Grant Proposal*, if approved (the Foundation will respond to this person and copy the author of the *Letter of Inquiry*, if different).
9. ***Website.*** The organization's website, or the program's if it has a separate site.
10. ***Affirmation.*** Statement that the program for which you seek funding is a Conforming Program (see *Grantmaking Guidelines* for the definition).

Many of the above items may be expressed in a single sentence—significant explanatory detail is not required. Other information may be included so long as the *Letter* does not exceed two pages.

Preparing a Regular Grant Proposal

Any organization that has been invited to do so may submit a regular *Grant Proposal* (one for more than $5,000)—this applies to self-initiated applicants with an approved *Letter of Inquiry* and Foundation-invited applicants. Currently, *Grant Proposals* are considered quarterly and are due not later than March 31, June 30, September 30, or December 31 each year.

A regular *Grant Proposal* is made up of four forms:

- *Grant Proposal Cover Form*
- *Organizational Due Diligence Questionnaire*
- *Supporting Documentation*
- *Request to Support a Program*

First-time Applicants

Complete all four documents.

Re-applying Applicants, Years 2 & 3

Complete only two forms: the *Grant Proposal Cover Form* and the *Request to Support a Program*.

Re-applying Applicants, Year 4

If the *Organizational Due Diligence Questionnaire* and its *Supporting Documentation* are more than three years old, complete the updated organizational due diligence process to submit a *Grant Proposal*. This is made up of five forms:

- *Grant Proposal Cover Form for Revised Due Diligence*
- An updated version of your organization's original *Organizational Due Diligence Questionnaire*
- *Revised Organizational Due Diligence Questionnaire*
- *Revised Supporting Documentation*
- *Request to Support a Program*

You may request that the Foundation provide the Word file of your prior *Organizational Due Diligence Questionnaire* form. This form must be edited to bring it current.

Table of Required Forms

The following table summarizes the forms needed to submit a *Small Grant Proposal* or a first-time or re-application *Grant Proposal* for a regular grant.

	Forms Required							
Type of Application	Small Grant Proposal	Grant Proposal Cover Form	Grant Proposal Cover Form for Revised Due Diligence	Organizational Due Diligence Questionnaire	Revised Organizational Due Diligence Questionnaire	Supporting Documentation	Revised Supporting Documentation	Request to Support a Program
Small grant (up to $5,000)	X							
Regular Grant (larger than $5,000)								
First-time Applicant		X		X		X		X
Re-applying Applicant, Years 2 & 3		X						X
Re-applying Applicant, Year 4			X	Revised	X		X	X

Submission

All forms must be mailed to:

Ms. Marin Kraushaar
Executive Director
Georgia's Own Foundation, Inc.
1155 Peachtree Street
Post Office Box 105205
Atlanta, GA 30348

In addition, the *Grant Proposal Cover Form, Organizational Due Diligence Questionnaire,* and *Request to Support a Program* (or the revised versions, if applicable) must be emailed as Word files to mckraushaar@georgiasown.org.

Access to Forms

Forms may accompany this *Grant Proposal Process*. However, if you need forms please email Ms. Marin Kraushaar, mckraushaar@georgiasown.org, who will provide PDF versions.

The Foundation looks forward to receiving your *Grant Proposal*.